

# THE MAN OF MILLENNIUM



*Shankar Nag*

Karate King

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## *Note*

“Almost two decades down the road, Shankar Nag is still remembered by the people of karnataka.



A whole generation of youngsters has grown up hearing about the man from their parents and seniors, seeing his image on almost every auto and watching his films on television.....like seeing pieces of a jigsaw puzzle, never getting to see the whole. I hope this book will take us on a journey of Shankar Nag's life and give younger generation the essence of the spirit of shankar Nag which was definitely worth emulating.”

## 1. Who Is Shankar Nag ?

Shankar Nag was a popular actor and director of Kannada cinema. you name him and you will see how people around you would love to remember him, his artistry and his personality.

*Shankar Nag*



Dynamism, Zestfulness & Full-Of-Life – this was Shankar in a few words. Shankar was not just a theatre and cinematic personality. He is known to have been a great painter, writer and a poet. The Full Name of Shankar Nag is Shankar Nagarkatte.

*If Shankar is a “wave”, his talent is the “ocean”.*

## 1.1 Birth Place & Family

Shankar Nag was born on 9 November 1954 in Mallapur village near Honnavar, Karnataka to a Konkani-speaking Chitrapur Saraswat Brahmin family . His parents were Anandi and Sadanand Nagarkatte. Apart from his mother-tongue Konkani, Shankar was fluent in Kannada and Marathi.

## 2. Early Career

After completing formal education, Shankar moved to Mumbai. In Mumbai, he was attracted to Marathi theater and immersed himself in theatrical activities. Incidentally, he met his future wife, Arundhathi during a drama rehearsal.





Shankar Nag then shifted base to Karnataka. His elder brother Anant Nag had already established himself as an actor and urged Shankar to act in films. He was offered a role of a mercenary by Girish Karnad in the epic movie, Ondanondu Kaladalli, which was loosely based on Akira Kurosawa's masterpiece, Seven Samurai.



His debut film as actor fetched him a national award at the Delhi International Film Festival. Thus began his film career, where, in a span of 12 years (from 1978 to 1990) he acted in some 90 Kannada movies, as a leading man, besides co-producing (with actor-brother Anant Nag ) and directing some films like 'Minchina Ota' (a rare example of a heist movie in Kannada), "Janma Janmada Anubandha" and "Geetha" (both of which had music by South Indian maestro Ilayaraja).

*"To Finish the work you just begin.."*

~ Shankar Nag

### 3.Later Days

Commercial film producers took notice of Shankar Nag and he began acting in typical masala movies.

Shankar was an unconventional hero with an unshaven face, distinct swagger, dark eyes and a rough voice.



Although he had never undergone any martial arts training, he earned the sobriquet of Karate King. His popular films include Auto Raja, Geeta, S.P.Sangliana, and Minchina ota.

He had also identified himself with the Janata Party in 1980s.

### 3.1 Directorial Debut

Shankar began his directorial with *Minchina Ota*. This won him seven state awards, including the best film. And then came a series of films directed by him. *Janma Janmada Anubandha*, *Geetha*, *Accident* (1985 film) (which won many state and national awards), *Ondu Muttina Kathe* (with Dr. Rajkumar in the lead).

Several articles on Shankar which claimed that Shankar never ever wasted even a single minute of his life – it was so productively used towards the medium of art, it would end up in Shankar spending less than four hours of sleeping in a day.



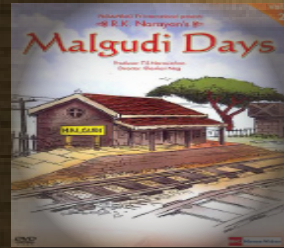
As a debutant-actor in *Ondhanondhu kaaladhalli* to making brilliant movies like *Accident*, *Minchina Ota*, *Geetha* to his TV Serial *Malgudi Days*, one thing that demands a standing ovation to this artist is his unbiased professionalism and sheer passion in dedicating his talent, fully justifying to each of these professions to the best.



## 3.2 Malgudi Days

Shankar did not limit his creativity to cinema. He was equally immersed in theater and television. Malgudi days is the best example of Shankar's oeuvre on television. Prior to globalization, Doordarshan was the only broadcaster in India.

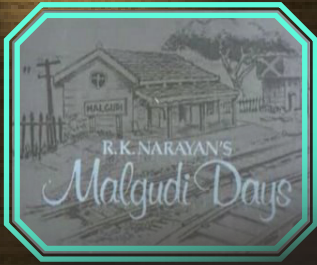
In addition to programme production, Doordarshan used to invite private television serials producers to produce. Shankar accepted the offer and directed Malgudi days, based on the collection of short stories by R.K.Narayan in 1987, under the banner of Padam Rag Films.



Well known actors Vishnuvardhan, and Anant Nag appeared in the serial. Master Manjunath, who essayed the role of impish Swami became a household name.

The music, accompanied by the nasal twang “Tananaa tana naa” was composed by L. Vaidyanathan. The teleserial was shot in Agumbe, Shimoga district, Karnataka. Shankar went to direct another teleserial, titled Swami in the same year.

Malgudi days has been rated as one of the finest serials ever to be made in the history of Indian Television.



Malgudi Days, adapted from the works of the literary titan R. K. Narayan. Malgudi Days is a mirror of Shankar's personality – Full-of-life, beaming with energy and living at the Edge-Of-The-Moment. Such perfection in direction was seldom seen on a big.

screen those days let alone watching it on a Television . At the cut of the climax, the reverberating-melodic tune of Malgudi Days (composed by Vaidyanathan) would penetrate and soothe our moods, melting all the heaviness of the story.

Malgudi Days has been blazingly awarded as one of the finest serials ever that could be made in the history of World Television.



## 4. Shankar Nag

### 4.1 As a Director

| Selected filmography     |      |
|--------------------------|------|
| Minchina ota             | 1980 |
| Janma Janmada Anu-bandha | 1980 |
| Geetha                   | 1980 |
| Nodi Swamy Navirodu Hige | 1983 |
| Lalach                   | 1983 |
| Accident                 | 1985 |
| Swami (TV Series)        | 1989 |
| Ondu Muttina Kathe       | 1987 |
| Malgudi days (TV Series) | 1987 |
| Hosa Teerpu              | -    |

## 4.2 As a Actor

| Year | Film                                                                                                                                                                |
|------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1978 | Ondanondu Kaladalli                                                                                                                                                 |
| 1979 | I Love You<br>Seetharamu                                                                                                                                            |
| 1980 | Moogana Sedtu<br>Haddina Kannu<br>Preeti Madu Tamashe Nodu<br>Ondu Hennu Aaru Kannu<br>Rustum Jodi<br>Janma Janmada Anubandha                                       |
| 1981 | Thayiya Madilalli<br>Maha Prachandaru<br>Kari Naga<br>Minchina Ota<br>Hana Balavo Jana Balavo<br>Muniyana Maadari<br>Jeevakke Jeeva<br>Geetha<br>Bhari Barjari Bete |
| 1982 | Benki Chendu<br>Nyaya Ellide<br>Karmika Kallanalla<br>Auto Raja<br>Archana                                                                                          |

|      |                                                                                                         |
|------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1983 | Nodi Swamy Navirodu<br>Hige<br>Raktha Thilaka<br>Chandi Chamundi<br>Nagabekkamma Nagabeku<br>Gedda Maga |
| 1984 | Ganda Bherunda<br>Utsav (Hindi)<br>Apoorva Sangama<br>Benki Birugali<br>Thaliya Bhagya<br>Asha Kirana   |
| 1985 | Maanava Danava<br>Parameshi Prema Prasanga<br>Thayiya Kanasu<br>Accident                                |
| 1986 | Na Ninna Preetisuve<br>Rasthe Raja                                                                      |
| 1987 | Antima Ghatta<br>Digvijaya<br>Ee Banda Anubandha<br>Lorry Driver<br>Huli Hebulli<br>Thaayi              |



|         |                                                                                                                 |
|---------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1988    | Sangliana<br>Mitheleya Seetheyaru                                                                               |
| 1989    | Anthintha Gandu Nannalla<br>Tharka<br>CBI Shankar                                                               |
| 1990    | Ramarajyadalli Rakshasa-<br>ru<br>Maheshwara<br>SP Sangliana<br>Nighooda Rahasya (Last<br>film)<br>Hosa Jeevana |
| 1991    | Punda Prachanda<br>Sundara Kanda<br>Nagini                                                                      |
| 1993    | Prana Snehitha                                                                                                  |
| Unknown | JayaBheri                                                                                                       |
| Unknown | Halliya Surasuraru                                                                                              |

## 4.3 As A Theater Lover

Though a busy star in his own rights, Shankar always had time for theatre. That was almost his second nature. In fact he brought a kind of commercial viability to the Kannada Amateur Theatre. He and his wife founded SANKET, an amateur theatre group, which still produces plays. His first ever directorial effort in Kannada was Anju Mallige by Girish Karnad.



He continued with productions like Barrister, Sandhya Chhaya. Sometime here he was joined by T N Narasimhan who wrote and co-directed Nodi Swami Navirodhu Heege. which had, apart from him self, his wife

Arundhati Nag and Ramesh Bhat in the cast.

The two directed Aata Bombat. Shankar's last production was Naaga Mandala, a play by Girish Karnad. He co-directed with Surendra Nath. Sanketh was a trust founded by Shankar to promote stage. Stage was Shankar's first love (and last love) though Shankar will be more remembered as a cinematic personality. The seed that was buried then by Shankar, is what is grown today to a tree laden with fruits at Ranga Shankara, a state-of-the-art theatre completed by his equally talented wife Arundati Nag.

## 5.The End Of Creator

Shankar Nag died in a car crash at Anagodu village on the outskirts of Davanagere town on the morning of 30 September 1990, while proceeding to Dharwad with his wife Arundhati Nag and daughter Kavya, for the shooting of his film Jokumaraswamy.

Shankar Nag left many unfinished projects like the Country Club at his farm near Bangalore, a ropeway to Nandi Hills and a low cost prefab housing scheme. An admirer of Ramakrishna Hegde, he was not much into active politics. However he had a great vision for Bangalore. Way back in 1990, before his untimely death, he proposed a Metro for Bangalore city, based on what he had seen in London. He started the first ever electronic recording studio, in Karnataka, Sanket Electronics.

Almost every film artist was in tears, and it only goes to show how truly a loss it was with the sudden demise of Shankar.

If Shankar had been alive today, Kannada Film Industry would be seen in world map of cinema – big and bold, proudly standing like a peacock.

A lamp that flashed like a wave, a lightening without a thunder, a silver-line without the dark cloud, a rose without a thorn is what Shankar was to industry, specially the Kannada film industry.

## ***Note From Author***

*All the information in this book is taken from following Reference sites*

- 1) [http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Shankar\\_Nag](http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Shankar_Nag)
- 2) <http://www.shankarnag.in/>
- 3) <http://www.ourkarnataka.com/Articles/sreesha/shankarnag.htm>

*Shankar Nag is remembered more for his creativity and inovative ideas for improving society rather than as a film actor.*

*If a person doesn't know about Shankar Nag then surely that person is not a Kannadiga. Today he might be not present with us but he will be always present in millions of kannadiga's heart.*

*If unknowingly anykind of information about any person is represented incorrectly then i apologize for it ....*

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